# Recommendation: approve a limited, evaluated extension

DECISION BOTTOM LINE

## Approve a limited, evaluated extension, subject to an approved budget and agreed success criteria. Defer full rollout.

## +11 percentage points

**Observed completion lift**

580 to 690 per 1,000 (+19.0% relative lift)

## +11 percentage points

**Observed outcome lift**

440 to 550 per 1,000 (+25.0% relative lift)

## About AUD727

**Cost per additional outcome observed**

Per additional completion or recorded outcome

**Targeting caveat:** Target low-performing programs only where prior results and diagnosed barriers support mentoring. The pilot shows no proven greater benefit for that subgroup.

GOVERNANCE REQUIREMENT

Review statistical and operational evidence before approving each further batch. Do not commit to unverified scale.

Made with GAMMA

STRATEGIC CONTEXT & EVALUATION MANDATE

# Business problem: improve completion and participant outcomes

**OBJECTIVE**

Grad Careers wants to improve workshop completion and participant outcomes.

**PILOT & EVALUATION**

A four-week pilot compared usual delivery with an employer mentor add-on.

Evaluation focus: completion, recorded outcome rates, statistical evidence, and cost-effectiveness to inform further investment.

Completion and outcomes are distinct measures.

**Measurement definition:** The precise outcome definition and measurement window require confirmation. The brief describes an employment outcome, but the dataset contains only OutcomeAchieved.

Made with GAMMA

DATA INTEGRITY & TRIAL STRUCTURE

# Groups have equal sizes; baseline comparability is unconfirmed

TRIAL STRUCTURE OVERVIEW · 40 PROGRAMS, 2,000 UNIQUE PARTICIPANTS

| Group | Delivery | Programs | Participants | Per program |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Control | Usual program without mentor add-on | 20 | 1,000 | 50 |
| Mentor (Variant) | Usual program plus mentor add-on | 20 | 1,000 | 50 |

### Cluster design

Each program sits wholly in one group. Participants share program conditions, so their results may be correlated. Assignment method is unconfirmed. Randomisation is not documented.

### Data checks

Checks found no duplicate participant IDs, missing source values, or inconsistencies between group and recorded mentor status.

### Matched pairs

Program IDs do not establish matched pairs. Equal counts do not establish comparability.

Source: verified Grad_Careers_Mentor_Evaluation.xlsx, Raw Data and Data Checks.

Recommendation: approve a limited, evaluated extension

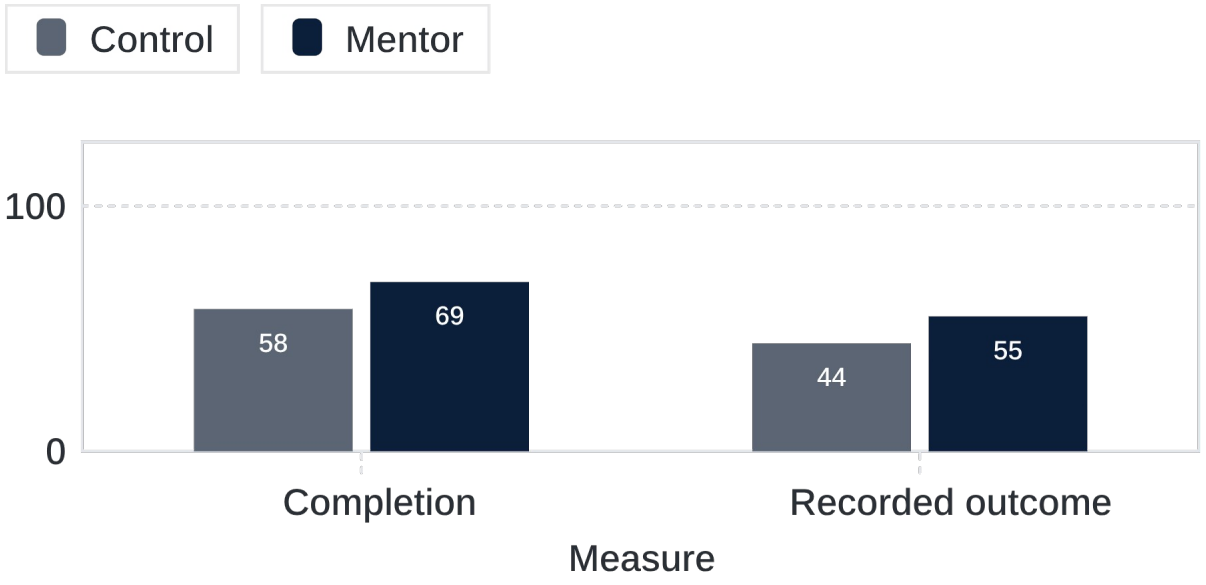
Made with GAMMA

COMPARATIVE PERFORMANCE · KEY METRICS

# Mentor group recorded higher completion and outcome rates

*Across equally sized groups of 1,000 participants, mentor rates were 11 percentage points higher for both measures: +19.0% relative lift for completion and +25.0% for recorded outcome.*

RECORDED PARTICIPANT RATES BY GROUP (%)




OBSERVED DIFFERENCES BREAKDOWN

| Metric | Control | Mentor |
|---|---|---|
| Participants | 1,000 | 1,000 |
| Completions | 580 (58.0%) | 690 (69.0%) |
| Recorded outcomes | 440 (44.0%) | 550 (55.0%) |

**Participants may appear in both measures.** 110 additional completions and 110 additional outcomes were observed. These may overlap and must not be added as 220 distinct beneficiaries.

Made with GAMMA

INFERENTIAL TESTING & STATISTICAL RIGOR

# Statistical evidence supports the observed differences

METHODS

**Participant level (N = 2,000)**

Chi-squared test of independence. Assumes independent participants.

**Program level (40 programs)**

Two-sided Welch t-tests on 20 program rates per group. Assumes independent programs.

RESULTS

**Participant level**

Completion $p < 0.001$ · Outcome $p < 0.001$

**Program level**

Completion $p < 0.001$ · Outcome $p < 0.001$

**Caveat:** Assignment and baseline comparability are unconfirmed. Statistical significance does not establish causation or financial value.

Made with GAMMA

FINANCIAL EVALUATION & EFFICIENCY ECONOMICS

# Cost-effectiveness is about AUD727 per observed additional result

## AUD80,000

**Estimated pilot add-on cost**

AUD4,000 per program × 20 mentor programs

## AUD727.27

**Cost per additional completion**

AUD80,000 ÷ 110 additional completions observed

## AUD727.27

**Cost per additional outcome**

AUD80,000 ÷ 110 additional outcomes observed

### Calculation method

Total mentoring expenditure divided by additional results observed.

### Cost-effectiveness vs ROI

These are cost-effectiveness measures, not commercial revenue, profit, return on investment (ROI), or break-even returns.

RESOURCING SCOPE QUESTION

Confirm whether mentor recruitment, vetting, training, coordination, and central administration are fully absorbed within the assumed AUD4,000 per-program charge.

**Unverified:** the full cost breakdown and the incremental renewal contribution. Any renewal benefit is a potential benefit requiring evidence.

Made with GAMMA

# Next steps: fund only against explicit decision conditions

1. **Program lead:** Diagnose barriers. Propose programs with suitable barriers.
2. **Evaluation lead:** Confirm outcome, follow-up and assignment. Predefine the primary metric and review criteria. Where feasible, randomise programs and retain a comparison group.
3. **Finance and funders:** Confirm full costs. Agree an acceptable cost per additional outcome.
4. **Delivery lead:** Confirm mentor capacity, quality and full resourcing.
5. **Leadership:** Approve a limited extension with a set budget and agreed criteria.

> **Pause if:** results are inconclusive, agreed criteria are unmet, costs overrun, or delivery quality slips.



Made with GAMMA